

August

17

Also on this day

1612 One of the most famous witch trials in England began in Pendle, Lancashire, UK. Of the 10 people accused of witchcraft, all but one were found guilty and executed.

2015 A study of the fossils of *Montsechia vidalii*, a prehistoric plant, revealed that it grew 125 million years ago, making it one of the world's oldest flowering plants.

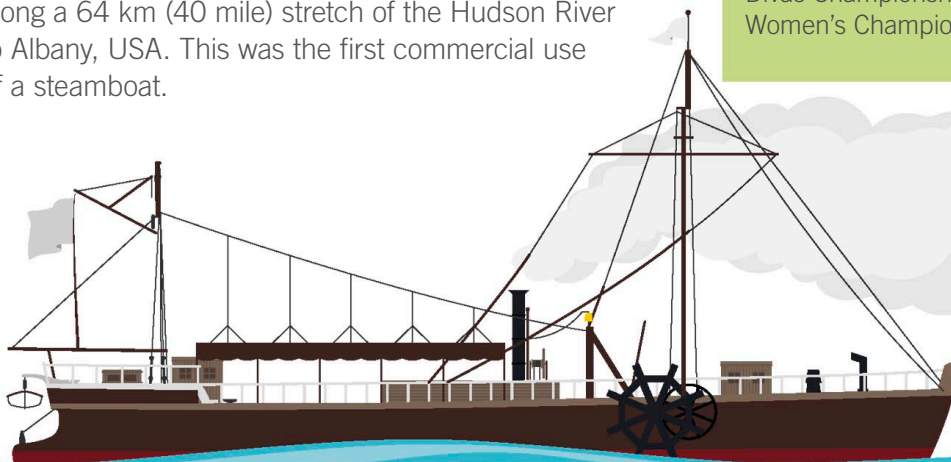


1908 Early animation

Fantasmagorie – the world's first hand-drawn animated film – was released. Created by French cartoonist and animator Émile Cohl, it featured a stick figure that interacted with different objects and characters.

1807 Full steam ahead!

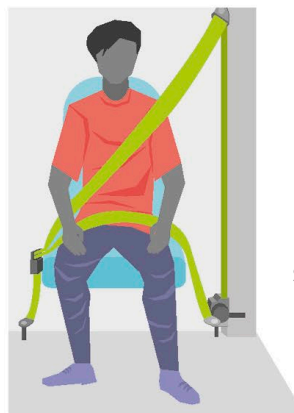
A steam-powered boat called the *Clermont*, built by US engineer Robert Fulton, set out from New York City, USA, to ferry passengers along a 64 km (40 mile) stretch of the Hudson River to Albany, USA. This was the first commercial use of a steamboat.



1959

Road safety

Nils Bohlin of Swedish car company Volvo filed a patent for his three-point seatbelt design. Instead of charging their competitors



money to use the design, Volvo made the patent free for all, which made it a standard safety feature in cars today.

Born this day

1992 Saraya Jade-Bevis, British wrestler. Known as Paige, she is the youngest winner of the WWE Divas Championship and the NXT Women's Championship.